

Viral Load Protocol

Carry out qRT-PCR amplification in dedicated facilities (avoid presence of relevant DNA, e.g. of plasmid origin).

Care should be exercised when handling RNA, which is very labile. Work diligently and swiftly. Always wear clean gloves.

Keep samples on ice, especially RNA and mixes prior to the RT conversion step.

Include standards when quantifying your samples!

QRT-PCR AMPLIFICATION

In **pre-PCR room**, prepare a reaction mix for n+1 reactions by mixing the following:

- 1 µL F-522 primer at 10 µM
- 1 µL R-643 primer at 10 µM
- 2 µL H₂O
- 10 µL Taqman Master Mix
- 1 µL RT/RNase Block (**as last step**)

Dispense 15 µL of the above mix in each PCR tube; add 5 µL of RNA sample. Quick-spin the Plate

Start qRT-PCR reaction using program 1 on the ABI 7500 Fast Real-Time PCR System:

10 minutes at 50°C	
3 minutes at 95°C	
15 seconds at 95°C	} 40 cycles
30 seconds at 60°C	

(To determine any contamination with plasmid DNA, prepare the same master mix **without** reverse transcriptase. Amount of the resulting DNA can be subtracted to obtain the correct RNA viral load.)